

Question 43 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain on-the-job and off-the-job training methods with suitable examples.

Introduction

A training method is the way learning is organised. The two big families are on-the-job (learn while doing real work) and off-the-job (learn away from the daily workstation). A good 8-mark answer defines, gives examples, advantages, limitations, and says choice depends on objectives.

Detailed points

- 1. On-the-job training (OJT) — meaning.** The employee learns in the actual work setting, usually guided by a supervisor or experienced worker, using real tools and real (or carefully selected) tasks.
- 2. OJT examples.** Coaching, job rotation, apprenticeship, internship, understudy (shadowing a senior), instruction by supervisor, action-learning projects on live problems.
- 3. OJT advantages and limits.** Advantages: high relevance, cheaper extra cost, easier transfer, real context. Limits: coach may be unskilled or busy; production pressure; learning of bad habits; safety risk on dangerous machines.
- 4. Off-the-job training — meaning.** Learning away from the regular job — classroom, workshop, vestibule (simulated workplace near the factory), external institute, or conference — so attention is on learning, not output.
- 5. Off-the-job examples.** Lecture, discussion, case study, role play, management games, sensitivity training, vestibule training, simulation, outdoor/experiential programmes, formal courses.
- 6. Off-the-job advantages and limits.** Advantages: focus, expert faculty, safe practice, conceptual depth, mixing with other participants. Limits: cost, time away from work, transfer problem if classroom is unlike the job, possible irrelevance.
- 7. Comparison for the exam.** OJT is usually better for routine practical skills already present in the workplace. Off-the-job is better for new concepts, dangerous tasks, and when the workplace itself teaches the wrong method.
- 8. HRD view — blend.** Most development programmes should combine both: concept off-the-job, skill on-the-job, with coaching. Method is a servant of TNA objectives.

Conclusion. Define both, give 3 examples each, one advantage and one limit each, and conclude that HRD blends methods according to the need.